

BRAND GUIDELINES — V1.0 — JUNE 2026

FUTURE AI GUIDE

The visual, editorial, and operational identity for the premium investigative AI intelligence network. Every design decision, word, and workflow traced to a single source of truth.

Project FUTUREAIGUIDE OS Updated 2026-06-26

Stack WordPress · Elementor · Next.js · Figma Prefix fg-

CONTENTS

01	Mission & Brand Philosophy	02	Identity & Positioning
03	Color System	04	Typography
05	Spacing & Layout	06	Components
07	Motion & Shadow	08	Icon System
09	Editorial Voice	10	AI Agents
11	Productivity System	12	Rapid Launch
13	Non-Negotiable Rules		

01 — MISSION & BRAND PHILOSOPHY

Why we exist

Future AI Guide occupies the evidence-based gap between AI maximalism (every release is revolutionary) and AI catastrophism (doom, doom, doom). We exist to make AI claims admissible — not louder, not prettier, not scarier. Admissible.

MISSION

Investigative AI Intelligence

A premium investigative AI media and intelligence network. Direct, evidence-

EDITORIAL CONTRACT

Claims Must Be Admissible

Every claim is traceable to an approved source, a visible design reference, a named user need, or an

aware, visually disciplined, technically literate, and unwilling to trade credibility for speed.

explicit strategic decision. We separate claims from interpretation. No invented facts.

BRAND COMPARABLE

Bloomberg · Apple · Palantir

The experience should feel like it belongs to institutions that combine data authority, visual discipline, and technical credibility — premium, restrained, and built to last.

The Doctrine in One Line:

Make AI claims admissible — not louder, not prettier, not scarier. Admissible.

CORE VALUES

Editorial authority — public-interest AI literacy and trust above all.

Source integrity — every output traceable, every claim reviewable.

Mature restraint — never trade credibility for speed or novelty.

Launch momentum — move fast, but not at the cost of mobile behavior, accessibility, or accuracy.

TONE SIGNATURE

Controlled menace — not alarming, not reassuring. Precise.

First-person investigation — we researched this. Here is what we found.

Data-aware hierarchy — the most important signal surfaces first.

Technically literate — we translate AI concepts accurately, never dumbing down, never inventing complexity.

02 — IDENTITY & POSITIONING

Brand architecture

Two faces, one operating system. Future AI Guide is the intelligence platform and directory. Did AI Do That? is the editorial investigation arm under the same design system.

PLATFORM BRAND

Future AI Guide

The intelligence platform, resource directory, knowledge center, and agent hub. Dark, data-driven, authoritative. URL: futureaiguide.com

EDITORIAL BRAND

Did AI Do That?

The investigative journalism arm. Case-file format, evidence classification, verdict taxonomy. URL: didaidothat.com



Status Badges



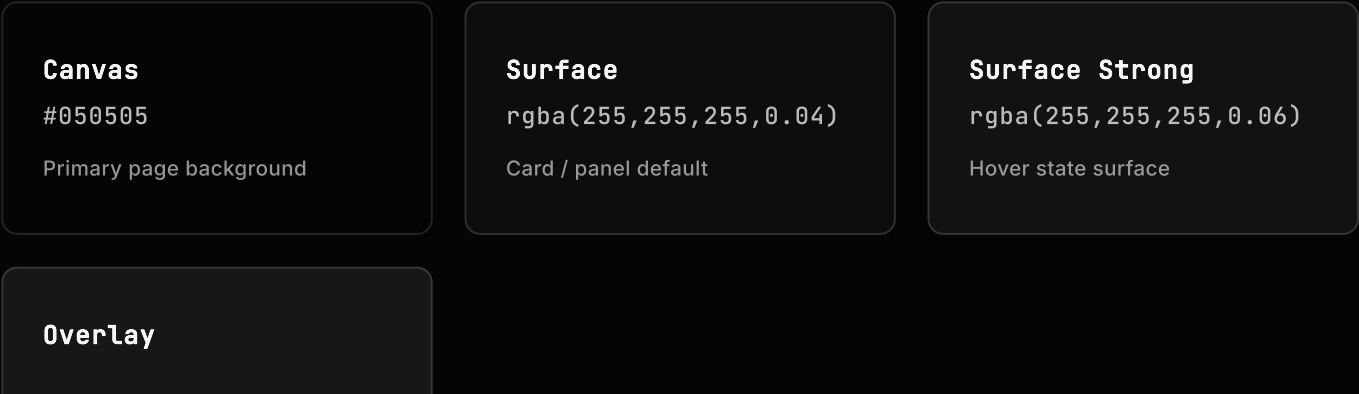
Naming Convention: All files, CSS variables, WordPress slugs, and component handles use the **fg-** prefix. Example: **fg-template-homepage-hero.v1.json**

03 — COLOR SYSTEM

Color tokens

Black foundation, restrained glass surfaces, orange for action and urgency, lime for verification and trust. Every color decision maps to a semantic token — never use raw hex in component code.

FOUNDATION



`rgba(255,255,255,0.08)`
Modal / overlay surface

BRAND COLORS

Orange 500 — Primary Action

`#ff5f1f · --fg-orange`

CTAs, active states, urgency, breaking news, primary buttons

Lime 500 — Verified / Trust

`#a3e935 · --fg-lime`

Verified badges, confirmed states, trust signals, green system accents

Orange 600 — Hover

`#ff7a45`

Orange 700 — Pressed

`#d9480f`

Lime 400 — Hover

`#b9f566`

Lime 600 — Pressed

`#7abf26`

STATUS & SEMANTIC

Amber 500

`#f59e0b`

Warning, caution, under review, investigating

Rust 600

`#ff4444`

Danger, threat, breach, critical, breaking alert

Neutral 100

`#f5f5f5`

Primary text on dark backgrounds

Neutral 500

`#737373`

Inactive, archived, disabled, closed state

Color Rule: Never use raw hex values in component code. Always reference a CSS variable: `var(--fg-orange)`, `var(--fg-lime)`, `var(--fg-surface)`. Token file: `fg-css-variables.v1.css`

04 — TYPOGRAPHY

Type system

Three font families, each with a specific role. Space Grotesk carries authority in headlines. Inter handles everything legible at body scale. JetBrains Mono grounds data and code in technical precision.

HEADING — SPACE GROTESK

AI claims must be admissible.

Fallback: Inter Tight → Inter → Arial.
Used for all display text, section titles, card headlines, and navigation brand mark.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0123456789

BODY — INTER

The AI media landscape has two default modes. Neither is useful. FUTUREAIGUIDE occupies the evidence-based gap between them.

Fallback: Arial. Used for body copy, labels, captions, metadata, and all UI text at 16px and below.

MONO — JETBRAINS MONO

```
--fg-orange: #ff5f1f;  
--fg-lime: #a3e935;  
version: 1.0.0
```

Fallback: SFMono-Regular → Consolas. Used for tokens, code, dates, version strings, technical metadata, and label chips.

TYPE SCALE

Display XL

80px · weight 700
lh 1.2 · ls -0.02em

Future AI Guide

Display LG

64px · weight 700
lh 1.2 · ls -0.02em

Investigations

Display MD

48px · weight 700
lh 1.2 · ls -0.02em

AI Claims Verified

Heading LG

24px · weight 600
lh 1.35

Case File: OpenAI Safety Audit

Heading MD

19px · weight 600
lh 1.35

Evidence Classification System

Body LG

16px · weight 400
lh 1.6

The investigation examined internal communications, patent filings, and regulatory disclosures across a 24-month period.

Body SM

13px · weight 400
lh 1.5

Published 2026-06-26 · Source: Internal documents · Classification: Verified

Mono

fg-investigation-2026-06-01 · STATUS: VERIFIED · THREAT: HIGH

14px · weight 400

lh 1.5 · ls 0.02em

05 - SPACING & LAYOUT

Spacing scale & grid

4px base unit. Editorial large spacing between sections. Dense, data-aware spacing inside cards. All values map to the **fg-spacing** token scale.

SPACING TOKENS

- spacing-1 · 4px · Micro gap
- spacing-2 · 8px · Icon to label
- spacing-3 · 12px · Tag, chip inner
- spacing-4 · 16px · Base unit
- spacing-6 · 24px · Card padding
- spacing-8 · 32px · Section sub-gap
- spacing-12 · 48px · Card to card
- spacing-16 · 64px · Section padding
- spacing-20 · 80px · Hero padding

BORDER RADIUS

r-sm · 4px

r-md · 8px

r-lg · 16px

r-xl · 24px

r-full · pill

BREAKPOINTS

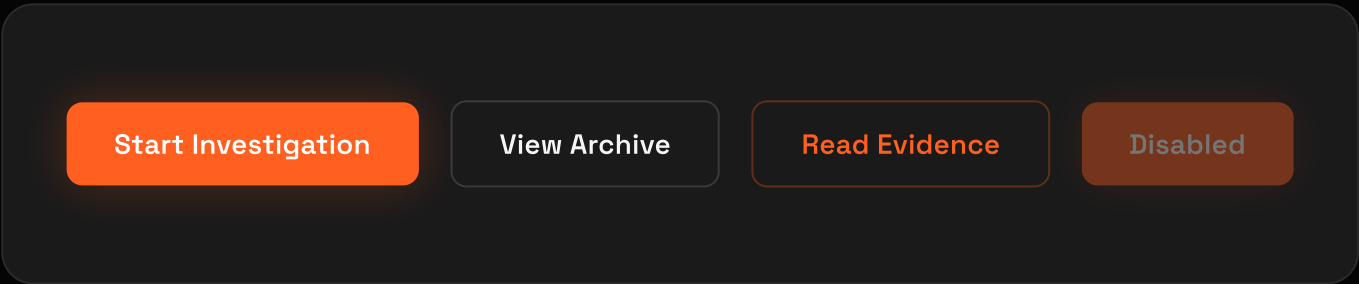
TOKEN	WIDTH	USE
mobile	390px	Base mobile
mobileLg	640px	Large phone
tablet	768px	iPad portrait
tabletLg	1024px	iPad landscape
desktop	1280px	Default desktop
desktopLg	1440px	Large desktop
wide	1920px	Wide display

06 — COMPONENTS

Component library

All components live in Figma as the visual source of truth, compiled into Elementor templates and Next.js/React primitives. Every component has a stable fg- prefix handle.

BUTTONS



INVESTIGATION CARDS

● BREAKING

COMPANY

OpenAI Deleted Internal Safety Memo Before Senate Hearing

2026-06-20 · 8 min read

Evidence from three internal sources indicates the document was removed from shared drives 48 hours before testimony.

✓ VERIFIED

GOVERNMENT

FTC AI Audit Reports Confirmed: 14 Violations Found

2026-06-18 · 12 min read

FOIA release confirms what sources indicated in March. Cross-referenced with three independent datasets.

● INVESTIGATING

TECHNOLOGY

Neural Network Patent Filings Contradict Public Claims

2026-06-15 · Active

USPTO records show 43 patents filed in categories publicly denied by the company's CTO at two investor briefings.

COMPONENT INVENTORY

HANDLE	COMPONENT	PLATFORM	STATUS
fg-hero	Hero Section (dashboard overlay variant)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-nav	Navigation Header (sticky, glass blur)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-card	Investigation Card (status stripe variant)	Elementor Loop · React	READY

HANDLE	COMPONENT	PLATFORM	STATUS
fg-badge	Status Badge (breaking, verified, etc.)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-button	Button (primary, secondary, ghost)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-cta	CTA Block (newsletter, tip submission)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-timeline	Event Timeline (investigation track)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-source-block	Source Citation Block (evidence type)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-evidence-grid	Evidence Grid (multi-source layout)	Elementor · React	READY
fg-footer	Footer (dark, editorial dense)	Elementor · React	READY

07 — MOTION & SHADOW

Animation & elevation

Motion should feel purposeful and restrained. No decorative animations. Every transition must serve legibility or signal interactivity. Shadow reinforces depth hierarchy on the black canvas.

DURATION TOKENS

EASING FUNCTIONS

TOKEN	VALUE	USE	TOKEN	CURVE	USE
instant	0ms	No animation (reduced motion)	default	cubic-bezier(0.4,0,0.2,1)	General UI
fast	150ms	Hover, focus, badge state	in	cubic-bezier(0.4,0,1,1)	Element exits
normal	250ms	Panel open, card expand	out	cubic-bezier(0,0,0.2,1)	Element entrances
slow	400ms	Page transition, overlay	spring	cubic-bezier(0.34,1.56,0.64,1)	Bouncy confirm state
slower	600ms	Hero entrance, data load			

SHADOW TOKENS

SHADOW-SM

0 1px 3px
rgba(0,0,0,0.4)

SHADOW-MD

0 4px 12px
rgba(0,0,0,0.5)

SHADOW-ORANGE

0 0 24px
rgba(255,95,31,0.25) ·
CTAs

SHADOW-LIME

0 0 16px
rgba(163,233,53,0.2) ·
Verified

SVG icon library

All icons are SVG, stored under `07_ASSETS/SVG/` with the `fg-svg-` prefix. Default fill: `var(--fg-text-2)`. Active / hover fill: `var(--fg-orange)`.



investigation



search



verified



warning



evidence



confidential



ai



companies



research



documents



timeline



news

Icon Rule: Icon size defaults to 20px inline / 24px standalone. Always use `fill: currentColor` so color is inherited via CSS. Never raster-export icons — always reference the SVG source from `07_ASSETS/SVG/`.

Voice & tone

The move is always: Claim → Mechanism → Implication. State what happened, explain how it happened, and make clear what it means. Never explain AI to readers as if they are five. Never treat them as emotional targets.

x DON'T

AI is revolutionizing everything! This groundbreaking new model from OpenAI is going to change the world and could be the most important thing to happen to humanity. You need to understand why this matters right now.

✓ DO

OpenAI's latest model achieved a 94.3% score on the MATH benchmark. That's a 12-point improvement over GPT-4. The mechanism is longer context and a revised chain-of-thought training approach documented in their technical report.

x DON'T

AI is going to destroy all the jobs and the robots are coming for everything you love. This is the end of work as we know it and experts are terrified. The catastrophe is already underway.

✓ DO

Bureau of Labor Statistics data shows 14 specific occupational categories with statistically significant displacement rates since 2023. Three of those are in sectors where AI adoption crossed 40% of tasks. Here is what the displacement actually looks like.

VOICE TRAITS

Direct — one sentence per claim, not three.

Specific — percentages, dates,

FORBIDDEN LANGUAGE

Never use: "game-changing",
"revolutionary", "terrifying",
"unprecedented", "you need to know",

document names.

Cold — no exclamation marks in editorial copy.

Authoritative — we found this. Here it is.

"the future is here", "could be", "might", "some experts say".

Replace vague with specific. Replace emotion with mechanism.

HEADLINE FORMULA

- Pattern 1:** [Entity] [Verb] [Specific Action]: [What It Means]
- Pattern 2:** [Number] [Finding] in [Entity]'s [Document/Data]
- Pattern 3:** The [Specific Claim]. [One Line Evidence Teaser].

10 - AI AGENTS

The agent system

Six specialized AI agents power the Future AI Guide editorial and publishing pipeline. Each agent has a defined role, system prompt, input specification, output format, and a mandatory human approval gate before any public-facing output is published.



Research Agent



Fact Check Agent

fg-openrouter-operator-prompt

fg-claude-operator-prompt · fg-gpt-operator-prompt

Processes a topic brief from the Research Queue sheet. Returns a structured research document with primary sources, key claims, entity relationships, and suggested evidence classification. Output saved to Google Drive.

▲ HUMAN REVIEW BEFORE BRIEF APPROVED

Receives an approved research brief and annotates every claim with a verification status: Verified, Unverified, Disputed, or Requires Source. Returns an annotated brief. Only verified claims pass to Writing Agent.

▲ HUMAN REVIEW BEFORE WRITING BEGINS



Writing Agent

fg-claude-operator-prompt

Takes verified claims and produces a full draft investigation in Case File format: header, evidence sections, source blocks, timeline, and verdict. Returns draft + 5 headline options + summary.

▲ EDITOR MUST MARK READY TO PUBLISH



SEO Agent

fg-openrouter-operator-prompt

Runs after Writing Agent. Returns SEO title, meta description, focus keyphrase, slug suggestion, and schema markup recommendations. Output appended to the same Google Doc draft.

▲ EDITOR REVIEWS BEFORE WP CREATION



Architect Agent

System-level · fg-cursor-operator-prompt

Reviews system sections, identifies the smallest set of decisions required to make work production-ready, and returns a prioritized action plan with dependencies, risks, and final deliverables.



Reviewer Agent

QA · All platforms

Audits completed work against the constitution: vague language, missing source references, brand drift, inaccessible design, automation risks, and anything that would slow launch execution.

▲ HUMAN APPROVAL BEFORE EXECUTION

▲ FINAL GATE BEFORE ANY PUBLIC CHANGE

Non-Negotiable Agent Rule: Every automation that can publish content, send email, post to social, or modify published records **REQUIRES** a human approval gate. No agent has autonomous publish rights. No exceptions.

11 — PRODUCTIVITY SYSTEM

Operating system for work

Future AI Guide runs on a documented operating system. Every repeatable decision becomes a named rule, component, prompt, checklist, template, or workflow — never solved from scratch twice.

FOLDER ARCHITECTURE

FOLDER	PURPOSE
02_DESIGN_SYSTEM	Tokens, components, Figma variables, SCSS
03_WORDPRESS	Theme, plugin, Elementor templates, ACF
04_AUTOMATION	Apps Script, OpenRouter workflows, blueprints

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

- SOP

Publish Article

Research → Fact check → Draft → SEO → Editor approval → WordPress → QA → Publish. File: **sop-publish-article.v1.md**
- SOP

Launch Investigation

Brief → Research agent → Fact check → Case file format → Evidence classification → Verdict → Publish. File: **sop-launch-investigation.v1.md**

FOLDER	PURPOSE
07_ASSETS	SVG icons, reference images, brand exports
09_AI_BRAIN	Operator prompts per AI platform, decision trees
10_LAUNCH	Roadmap, checklist, sprint plans
17_SOPs	Standard operating procedures for every task type
21_DOCUMENTATION	Audits, folder structure, missing systems
27_IMPORTS	CSS, SCSS, Elementor, Figma import-ready files

SOP

Create YouTube Video

Script from investigation → Visual outline → Record → Edit → Publish. File: **sop-create-youtube-video.v1.md**

SOP

Weekly Maintenance

Plugin updates → Backup → Analytics review → Content audit → SEO check. File: **sop-weekly-maintenance.v1.md**

CONTENT ARCHITECTURE

17 Custom Post Types registered. Investigations, Companies, People, Technologies, Events, Evidence, Verdicts, Sources, and more — all managed via ACF Pro field groups with structured metadata.

AUTOMATION STACK

Google Sheets → Apps Script → OpenRouter → Google Doc → WordPress REST API. Research Queue tab drives the pipeline. All outputs logged and human-reviewable before any CMS change.

TECH STACK

WordPress + Hello Elementor +
Elementor Pro + ACF Pro. Next.js +
React + TypeScript + Tailwind +
shadcn for the app layer. Figma as the
visual source of truth. Canva for fast
campaign assets.

12 — RAPID LAUNCH

Launch roadmap

Site launch is achievable in 27–39 hours of focused work across 9 sequential phases. The critical path is: design system → CPT+ACF → Investigation Card → Archive → Single Investigation → Header/Footer → Homepage → SEO → Launch.

P0 Environment 2-4 hrs
P1 Design System 3-4 hrs
P2 CPT + ACF 2-3 hrs
P3 Templates 8-12 hrs
P4 Content

	3-4 hrs
P5	
Automation	4-6 hrs
P6	
SEO	2 hrs
P7	
QA	2-3 hrs
P8	
Launch	1 hr

CRITICAL PATH

- 1

Design System in Elementor

Import `fg-css-variables.v1.css` → Configure 15 global colors → Set 4 global fonts → Apply theme styles → Enable Flexbox experiment. Duration: 3-4 hrs.
- 2

CPT Registration + ACF Import

Upload `fg-cpt-register.php` to mu-plugins → Flush permalinks → Import ACF JSON field groups → Verify all 17 CPTs. Duration: 2-3 hrs.
- 3

Build Investigation Card First

The Investigation Card (Loop Item template) is the P0 build. Everything else depends on this being correct and responsive across all breakpoints. Then: Archive → Single → Header/Footer → Homepage.
- 4

Seed 3 Investigations Before Launch

Import 3 investigations via CSV → Create 5 company profiles → Write About page → Set up Contact/Tip submission → Publish Privacy Policy.

5

QA Gates Before Go-Live

PageSpeed score target: 85+ mobile. WCAG 2.1 AA contrast on all text. Responsive check: 390px, 768px, 1280px. All 17 CPTs confirmed active. Automation test with dummy Research Queue row.

▲ FINAL SIGN-OFF REQUIRED BEFORE LAUNCH

13 — NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

Rules that cannot be traded away

These rules cannot be traded for speed, taste, convenience, or novelty. Any contributor — designer, builder, editor, automation agent, or launch operator — must be able to enforce them without asking for a second brief.

Rule 1 — Traceability: Every output must be traceable to an approved source, a visible design reference, a named user need, or an explicit strategic decision. No invented claims. No undocumented decisions.

Rule 2 — Visual Language: Every design choice must respect the FUTUREAIGUIDE visual language: black foundation, restrained glass surfaces, orange for action and urgency, lime for verification and trust, editorial spacing,

Rule 5 — Handoff Context: Every final deliverable must include enough context for the next person to continue the work without reopening the entire conversation that produced it. Name changed files, created assets, pending approvals, and the next recommended step.

Rule 6 — Mobile First: The team may move fast, but it may not ignore mobile behavior. Every layout must be reviewed at 390px, 768px, and 1280px before it is considered complete. No exceptions.

data-aware hierarchy, and mature restraint.

Rule 3 — Maintainability: Every WordPress and Elementor decision must be maintainable by a future operator. Avoid fragile one-off overrides when a global class, template, custom field, component, or reusable pattern would create a cleaner system.

Rule 4 — Human Gates: Every automation that can affect public claims, brand positioning, legal exposure, publishing, email, analytics interpretation, or irreversible site changes must include a human approval checkpoint.

Rule 7 — Accessibility: All text must meet WCAG 2.1 AA contrast ratios. All interactive elements must be keyboard accessible and have proper ARIA labels. Ship no inaccessible layouts.

Rule 8 — No Invention: Do not invent claims. Do not flatten the content hierarchy. Do not ship untested work. Do not bypass review gates. A reviewer must always be able to answer: What is the purpose? What source controls it? What has changed? What remains unresolved? What must happen next?

QA ACCEPTANCE CHECKLIST

CHECK	CRITERIA	CHECK	CRITERIA
Visual Hierarchy	Primary action is findable in 3 seconds at first viewport	Editorial Accuracy	Every claim sourced, no vague language
Responsive	Tested at 390px, 768px, 1280px, 1440px	Source Alignment	Design matches Figma spec, code matches tokens
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA contrast on all text elements	Handoff Complete	File named, owner noted, next step written
Performance	PageSpeed 85+ mobile, 90+ desktop	Human Gate	Approval documented before any public change

FUTURE AI GUIDE

Brand Guidelines v1.0 · FUTUREAIGUIDE OS · Updated 2026-06-26 · Prefix: fg- · futureaiguide.com

Source files: 02_DESIGN_SYSTEM/Tokens/fg-design-tokens.v1.json · fg-css-variables.v1.css · FUTUREAIGUIDE_MASTER_CONSTITUTION.md